

MY GRANDMOTHER'S PRAYER

My name is Shanthi Poojary and I am the oldest of six children. I have 5 brothers. My father works in a saree shop as a salesman. My mother is a housewife. My mother's mother, my Naniji, lives with us. Our house is small, with two rooms and 1 bathroom and with 9 people in the house, it is crowded.

In our crowded house, we have lots of noise and many conflicts. Naniji did not go to school. All of her education is from the school of Life. I call her the problem solver because every problem in our house is solved by her. She is also the judge for many conflicts our neighbors have. They all come to her and somehow she takes care of the problem and they all go away quite happy. I often think that she would have been a famous politician if she had been to school.

Speaking of school, not a day goes by without my naniji speaking to us about the importance of an education. She is up in the morning fixing breakfast and making sure our book bags are ready when we leave. She is waiting when we get home in the afternoon to greet us, have a snack for us, and then sit everyone down for homework. When I tell her all the homework was done she would say Very Good. And then she will ask me to read the newspaper to her. I think that is her way of making me learn about current events as much as for her.

She has such high hopes for me that I do not want to do anything to disappoint her. And I have set my goals for a degree in Computer Science and work in the best company and have a successful profession. I am interested in designing software that can make it easy for India to provide online classes to the rural parts of the country.

I have focused on my studies all through school. I believe in doing my best all the time because we have so many brilliant students who are competing for the same jobs. My efforts in school resulted in being the top student for the last 3 years. I also like to run. I don't need anyone to be a part of that nor do I need any expensive equipment. All I need is a pair of shoes and I love to feel the wind on my face as I set imaginary races.

My teachers are always encouraging me to keep my focus on my goals. The support from my naniji, my teachers and my friends, I am bound to reach my goals. College is expensive and money can be a barrier. So I am seeking assistance to reach my goals. I promise you that I will honor your faith and commit to serve in my success.